How the two sides connect

The public site serves exam information, alerts and book buyers. Staff use a protected admin area on the same domain to publish content, manage signups and operate the book business.

Newsline → homepage	Two admin entries matched the public ticker by title and destination. The ASB 2026 item points directly to a PDF. The TAC July 2026 item points to Important Downloads.
Books → product → checkout	The admin catalogue shows the TAC Examination Book as published. The homepage opens that book at /book/5. Its Buy now link opens /buy_now/5, with the same title, quantity, delivery details and pricing.
Checkout → Orders	Orders has Pending, Successful and Rejected queues, search by order number, mobile or name, and Excel export. The checkout and order list show corresponding buyer, delivery and price fields. The exact point at which an order is written remains to be tested.
Order → study material	The public login asks for a seven-digit book order ID and a password. Staff have a study-material library, PDF controls and an “Activate frontend Study Material for all” setting. Which payment states grant access needs a staging test.
Alert forms → staff lists	Officer and soldier forms each offer subscribe, unsubscribe and written-result registration. The two subscriber lists are separate in admin. Choosing result registration on the officer form opened a dedicated exam form.
Exam → centre → registration	Choosing the TAC exam changed the centre dropdown. The admin registration table contains roll number, exam name and centre, with search and Excel download by zone. This describes the legacy form. The rebuild collects the exam and roll number only, alongside contact details.

Evidence boundary

Read-only inspection of live screens. No production form submission, payment, publication, export or customer login was performed. Database structure, email/SMS delivery and gateway callbacks remain unverified.

What to carry forward

Use the existing proposal as the baseline: ₹50,000 one-time development, six weeks, 11 admin modules and CCAvenue. The following choices resolve differences between the proposal and the live interface.

Publishing and resources	Keep Pages, Slider, Newsline & Reviews, PDFs and Study Material. Support nested pages, preview, publication status and link targets. Give public downloads and buyer-only files different access rules. Preserve solved and practice paper routes.
Subscribers and exams	Keep Exam Names, Result Registration, Officer Subscribers and Soldier Subscribers. Use email verification and preserve opt-outs as specified in the proposal. Label the public alert channel accurately. Confirm an SMS provider and budget only if actual SMS delivery is required.
Books and orders	Keep Books and Orders. Retain book editions, quantity, price, delivery, order search and Excel export. Manual tracking on an individual order is optional. Confirm any automatic quantity discount and its rounding rule separately.
Excluded from the panel	Omit Exam Centres, Upload Consignment CSV and Coupons from menus, forms, settings, import tools and admin routes. Checkout has no coupon-code field. The earlier exclusion of “Move to 100% Officers” also applies.
Result registration	Collect name, mobile, email, exam name and roll number. Staff filter and export by exam. Where a legacy record already has a zone, allow a zone export using that stored value. New registrations require no centre or zone.
Design changes	Give mobile visitors four clear choices: notices and results, officer/soldier alerts, buy the exam book, and access study material. Put the latest notices above the history section. Label official-source links and identify the site’s exam-information and books purpose near commercial actions.

Scope decisions still open

Review the visual direction on page 6 and confirm the buyer-access policy, quantity pricing, rounding rule and manual tracking requirement. The existing proposal lists WhatsApp integration as an optional add-on.

How the rebuild should work

Proposed design: one Laravel application, public Blade templates, a role-based Filament admin and a shared MySQL database. Select supported, mutually compatible versions at kickoff. The live site’s internal architecture was not inspected.

1 Publish once, display where assigned

Store pages, menu parents, news items, target URLs, file visibility and publication state. Publishing or withdrawing a record refreshes the affected public menu, ticker or downloads list. Keep a draft preview and validate targets before publication.

2 Turn a book purchase into a traceable order

The server prices the book, quantity, discount and shipping, then saves a pending order and payment attempt. Send the order reference and amount to CCAvenue. Verify the merchant response and match order, amount and currency before recording success. Repeated callbacks must affect the order once. Reconcile interrupted attempts and record shipment status separately.

3 Give buyers predictable study access

Link an eligible order to its study-material entitlement. Preserve old order references as strings, including prefixed IDs visible in admin. Test which legacy ID formats were valid for the seven-digit login. Use a verified reset flow for customers and permission-checked downloads. Audit any temporary “open to all” change.

4 Route signups to the right list

Capture audience, contact details, consent and verification status. Deduplicate within each audience. An unsubscribe must suppress subsequent sends for that list. For results, store contact details, exam and roll number. Allow registration when a centre value is absent. Restrict exports to authorised staff and record who exported them.

Priority fix on the current site

The Orders table displayed readable customer passwords. Remove password values from screens and export queries, review access and existing exports, and arrange password resets. Store new passwords as salted one-way hashes. The screen establishes exposure to staff; storage format and exposure beyond staff were not verified.

Two defects to reproduce on staging

Changing quantity from one to two showed ₹3,397 on a ₹1,998 unit price, and PHP diagnostic text appeared in the discount field. Some historical orders displayed an invalid date. Validate tier pricing and whole-rupee rounding server-side. Preserve unknown dates explicitly during import.

Six-week build and acceptance plan

The estimate follows the existing proposal. Start once the team has a staging environment, authorised legacy extracts, source assets and access to the merchant test environment.

Week 1 · Scope and UX	Owner and designer approve the mobile journeys, data fields, access policy and list of exclusions. Developer inventories legacy URLs, file links, order identifiers, exams and any stored legacy zone values.
Week 2 · Publishing	Build roles, pages, menus, news, reviews, PDFs, study files and book catalogue. Demonstrate draft/publish/withdraw, review approval and public/private downloads using test content.
Week 3 · Forms and lists	Build officer and soldier verification, unsubscribe, exam selection, result registration and filtered exports. Submit a test registration with contact details, exam and roll number. Verify it appears in the matching exam export.
Week 4 · Commerce	Connect CCAvenue in test mode. Exercise success, failure, cancellation, duplicate response and interrupted return. Verify buyer login, recovery, quantity pricing and study access. Confirm staff cannot access coupon management or consignment upload and that checkout has no coupon-code field.
Week 5 · Migration rehearsal	Import content and files, then accounts, subscriptions, registrations and orders. Compare counts by type/status and order totals by group. Review duplicate contacts, invalid dates, old IDs and missing PDFs. Keep unsubscribed records suppressed.
Week 6 · Acceptance and handover	Staff run mobile and desktop acceptance tests. Check old URLs or redirects, protected file access, export permissions and database restore. Take a final backup, capture changes since rehearsal, reconcile, switch traffic and monitor payments and registrations.

Go-live criteria

Owner accepts representative workflows. One verified payment creates one paid order and the intended access. Public notices resolve correctly. Restricted PDFs reject unauthorised visitors. Migration differences are explained and approved. If orders or callbacks fail after cutover, pause checkout and reconcile transactions before rollback.

Basis: authenticated admin and public website reviewed on 10 November 2026; Territorial Army Website Proposal, revision 3; OWASP Password Storage Cheat Sheet. Handover in the proposal includes source code, 1–2 hours of training and 30 days of bug fixes.

Recommended technology stack

One server-rendered application serves public content, the bookshop and a staff-only admin. Using one catalogue and one order record keeps publication, price and buyer access consistent.

Application and database	PHP 8.4, Laravel 13, Eloquent and MySQL 8.4. Keep the public controllers and Filament resources on the same domain model. Store order references as strings and monetary amounts in integer paise.
Public templates	Blade, Tailwind CSS 4.1+, Vite and minimal Alpine. Render headings, product details and links in HTML. Use responsive images and self-hosted Barlow and Source Sans 3.
Staff panel	Filament 5 with Laravel policies, staff MFA and three roles: administrator, content editor and operations. Open shipping details on demand. Test export and payment permissions independently of sidebar visibility.
Media, mail and payments	Cloudflare R2 with separate public and protected files. Laravel queues for mail and reconciliation; choose SES or Resend. CCAvenue merchant checkout with verified responses and duplicate-event protection.
Deployment and testing	Proposed Hostinger VPS with Nginx, PHP-FPM, HTTPS, queue supervision and off-host backup. Use PHPUnit or Pest, Playwright, axe and Lighthouse CI. Commit dependency lockfiles and rehearse a restore.
Search measurement	Search Console, consent-aware analytics and template-level crawl tests. Track source clicks, verified alerts, checkout starts and confirmed purchases. Strip personal data from analytics and logs.

Compatibility at kickoff

Laravel 13 supports PHP 8.3–8.5. Filament 5 documents Laravel 11.28+ and Tailwind 4.1+ as minimums. Resolve the project packages on the actual target runtime and commit the tested versions.

Simpler navigation, stronger graphics

Give visitors a dated result, the right alert form or the book in one or two clicks. The wireframe shows the reading order and the role of each visual.

Exam guide Notices Prepare Books Study login

Territorial Army exam guide
Latest notices, preparation resources and book information. Primary action: View latest notices.

Hero photograph
One licensed landscape or training image. Place the photo below the action on mobile.

Notices & results

Officer / soldier alerts

Buy the book

Study login

Latest notices
Three dated items with descriptive links and a View all action.

Book feature
Real cover, edition, price and one Buy action.

Extend the same design across four page types

Notice detail: date, summary, issuing source and clearly labelled PDF. Preparation: separate solved papers from practice papers. Book: cover, edition, delivery and study access. Forms: one column, labels above fields, clear errors and recovery.

Choose graphics that identify the task

Use one real or licensed editorial hero, an approved book cover and four consistent pictograms with text labels. Keep essential text in HTML. Provide rights, alt text, responsive image variants and dimensions before launch.

Design checks

Use deep green on ivory, charcoal body text and restrained ochre accents. Check 360, 390, 768 and 1440 px layouts, keyboard focus, reduced motion and 200% zoom. Proposed mobile budgets are 180 KB for the hero and 100 KB of compressed initial public JavaScript.

Where the history goes

Keep history, policies and contact pages reachable through navigation or the footer. The first screen prioritises current notices and the four most useful tasks.

What the public sample showed

A rendered-page inspection on 10 November 2026 covered six URLs, including both homepage addresses. Counts describe this sample; search traffic, rankings and index coverage were unavailable.

6 of 6 URLs

Every sampled page had an empty document title, an absent or empty meta description, no H1, no HTML canonical link and no JSON-LD script. All 47 image occurrences lacked an alt attribute; shared images are counted on each URL.

Homepage / and /home	14 image occurrences at each address. Consolidate navigation at / and permanently redirect /home in one hop. Use a clear H1, a unique title and a visible route to the latest results.
Book /book/5	7 image occurrences. Map the old product URL to a descriptive book page. Use the real title, edition, price and cover. Implement Product/Offer and breadcrumb markup consistent with visible content.
Downloads and papers	4 image occurrences each on /imp_downloads, /pib_question_papers and /practice_test_papers. Give notices a dated HTML page linking to the source PDF. Keep past exam questions and practice sets as distinct landing pages.

Technical release checks

Crawl all approved legacy URLs and staging equivalents. Compare redirects, response codes, canonical tags, robots, headings, metadata, links and structured data. Keep public PDFs accessible at stable URLs and buyer files protected. Verify robots.txt and sitemap delivery. Lab-test mobile templates before launch.

Measure search outcomes

Collect a 28-day Search Console baseline when access is available. Segment by page type and device. At launch, day 7 and day 28 compare index coverage, clicks, CTR, verified signups and organic book conversion. Field performance targets at p75: LCP ≤2.5 s, INP ≤200 ms, CLS ≤0.1.

Sources: direct public-page inspection, Google Search Central site migration and product structured data guidance, and web.dev Core Web Vitals. The companion PRD includes the routes, redirect targets, test criteria and reference links.

Six implementation prompts

Put Territorial_Army_Claude_Code_PRD.md at the project root. Paste its Start here prompt into Claude Code. The Markdown file contains the detailed phase commands and acceptance tests.

01 Foundation and UI	Inspect the repository and lock dependencies. Build the responsive homepage, notice screen and book template with synthetic content. Deliver local setup and mobile/desktop screenshots. Prove that links and headings work without JavaScript.
02 Publishing	Connect the editor, hero media, PDFs, study library, book catalogue and reviews. Publish and withdraw a test notice. Check homepage, detail page, cache and sitemap together. Anonymous access to drafts and private files must fail.
03 Registrations	Build officer/soldier verification, unsubscribe and result signup. Test duplicate signups, suppression and exam-filtered export. Check role permissions and confirm the three excluded features are absent.
04 Payments	Build mobile checkout, CCAvenue adapter, order reconciliation and study access. Simulate failures, repeated responses and amount mismatches in CI. Verify the actual integration separately in the merchant sandbox.
05 Migration and SEO	Dry-run the import twice, compare paid totals and list suppressions, then crawl staging against the redirect inventory. Deliver an issue list with evidence and retest results, plus visual and mobile-performance checks.
06 Release candidate	Rebuild from a clean checkout. Rehearse restore, delta import and rollback. Hand over verified tests, staff instructions, the deployment checklist and a day 7/day 28 search measurement plan.

Ready for development

The existing ₹50,000 / six-week proposal is the planning baseline. The SEO brief defines engineering and analysis work. Confirm commercial coverage for the expanded audit, analytics configuration and post-launch reporting before scheduling those services.